

Deal 1 Ctr: 2♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 2 ♠

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: South

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 2

♥ Q J 7 2

♦ 7 3

♣ 10 9 5 4

♠ 10 6 5 4

♥ A K 3

♦ 9 6 4 2

♣ J 8



♠ A Q

♥ 10 8 5

♦ K Q J 10

♣ 7 6 3 2

♠ 9 8 7 3

♥ 9 6 4

♦ A 8 5

♣ A K Q

West

North

East

South

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♠

All Pass

2 ♠ by North

3 as long as the defenders don't get a ruff. But if the defender with a doubleton trump happened to get a ruff then your trump losers would go to 4. You should lead trumps to try to prevent this.

So win the ♦ A and lead a ♠. East will win and play 3 high ♦ s. You ruff the third one in dummy. West may over-ruff, and if he does you can hope that he was the defender who started with 3 trumps. Suppose West now leads a ♥. You win in your hand and play another trump, happily observing the ♠ K and ♠ A both fall. You win the rest of the tricks, discarding your ♥ loser on dummy's third ♣.

When the defenders have a lot of high trumps you have to try to make sure they fall on the same tricks.

You were a little lucky that the defender who got the ruff, West, was the one who started with 3 trumps.

There are three legitimate choices, 1 ♦, 1 ♠ or 1NT.

You should always show a Major suit if you can, even a poor one like this.

You bid 1 ♠. Partner says 2 ♠ and

Partner has a minimum opener. You pass in a flash.

North plays 2 ♠. East leads the ♦ K.

North plays 2 ♠. East leads the ♦ K.

Losers: ♠ 3? : ♥ 1 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 0 : Total = 6?

Your ♥ loser can disappear on dummy's third ♣.

If ♠ s split 3-2 you can hold your losers in the suit to 3 as long as the defenders don't get a ruff. But if the defender with a doubleton trump happened to get a ruff then your trump losers would go to 4. You should lead trumps to try to prevent this.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 10 7
 ♥ 10 5
 ♦ Q 7 2
 ♣ A Q 10 9 5

♠ 9 5 4 2
 ♥ A 9 6 3
 ♦ J 8 3
 ♣ K 4



♠ A K 3
 ♥ K 4
 ♦ A K 6 5
 ♣ J 8 7 2

♠ J 8 6
 ♥ Q J 8 7 2
 ♦ 10 9 4
 ♣ 6 3

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	1♦	Pass
All Pass		3NT	

3NT by East

you know that if you lose the lead there will be a deluge of ♥s on the table. ♣s is your best suit, and if the finesse works you will make 6. Of course if it fails you will go down. But there is one thing you should do before you stake everything on a 50% finesse. You should play 3 rounds of ♦s. If they split 3-3 you will have found your ninth trick and you won't risk the ♣ finesse.

If you try the ♣ finesse you will go down, losing 1 ♣ and 4 ♥s. If you take your 4 ♦ tricks and refuse to try the ♣ finesse you will make the contract.

The best thing about this plan is that when you test the ♦s, if it turns out they do not split 3-3 you can still try the ♣ finesse.

You are too strong to open 1NT. With two 4-card minors the correct opening bid is 1♦. Partner responds 2♣.

You now need to make a jump bid. You **MIGHT** jump to 4♣ but that would bypass what is probably your best game. Instead you just jump to 3NT. Partner doesn't **HAVE** to pass, but he does.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♥7 North wins ♥A and returns ♥9.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♥7 North wins ♥A and returns ♥9.

Winner count: ♠ 3 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 3 : ♣ 1 : Total = 8

You have a **LOT** of points - but only 8 tricks. And

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

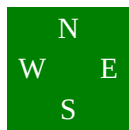
♠ Q J 9 4
 ♥ K Q 10 7
 ♦ J 10 8 2
 ♣ 9

♠ A 8 5 3

♥ A 6 4 2

♦ K 7

♣ A K 5



♠ K

♥ J 9 8 3

♦ Q 9 5 4 3

♣ 6 4 2

♠ 10 7 6 2

♥ 5

♦ A 6

♣ Q J 10 8 7 3

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South
 pull trumps. You win the ♥ A and play the ♠ A. East plays the ♠ K!

Do you change your Plan? Click?

Do you change your **PLAN**?

Well, East may be false-carding. He may also have the ♠ Q for example. But if you decide to play another trump and it turns out he was NOT false-carding you will be dead in the water. West will take his three trump tricks and some ♥s. Many ♥s.

So don't take the chance. Abandon trumps and start playing ♣ winners. Let West take the three trumps whenever he wants to. You will not lose control of the hand and will make your 10 tricks.

The risk of leading a second trump was too great.

As you see, West would have pulled your and dummy's trumps and then won 3 ♥ tricks.

A slightly different Plan would also have worked. At trick two you could have played a low trump from both hands. East would win the ♠ K, then probably play another ♥. You ruff, play a ♠ to the ♠ A and discover the split. From there the Plan is the same, play your ♣s and let West ruff when he wants.

Well, you're pretty sure you have a ♣ fit. But before you show partner your fine ♣ support you have an obligation to show a 4-card Major.

You respond 1 ♠, partner jumps to 3 ♠.

Your hand revalues to 11 or 12 points so you should bid game. 5 ♣ requires 11 tricks and 4 ♠ only 10 tricks. You bid 4 ♠.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♥ K.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♥ K.

Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 0 : Total = 2

You expect trumps to split 3-2 so you would lose 2 trumps. You have no other losers so you decide to